Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 Why did the son think that his father was a tedious oddity?
2 How do you understand the sentence "The civilization of Greece and the glory of Roman architecture were captured in a condensed non-statement" (Para. 4)?
3 Why does the author think that, in a sense, schools should be blamed for students' language deficits?
4 Why does the author say that the work of teaching grammar must be handled delicately?
5 What did the father teach the son while giving him a grammar lesson?
6 Why did the son feel curious about what his father said?
7 What are the two things that the author uses to describe grammar and vocabulary?
8 How do you understand the interjection "whoa!" said by the father at the end of the text?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 Does English grammar help a lot in English learning? Why or why not?
2 In what ways can students learn English grammar more effectively?
3 How can students successfully enlarge their vocabulary?
4 What is the importance of learning English?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

adequately adjust asset competent
condense deficit distinguish
exceed precise proficiency

1 The guest speaker decided to condense his speech in order to leave enough time for his audience to ask questions.
2 According to the media, China's wind power capacity has exceeded the previous level considerably.
3 Researchers conducted a set of psychological tests to determine the negative consequences of a sleep deficit.
4 In addition to a sense of sight, bees also have an unusual sense of smell, so they can distingguish more than 10 similar flower odors.
5 Moving forward even in the face of great difficulties has become the most important asset in my life and career.
6 The lawyer proclaimed that they couldn't jump to conclusions because acceptable conclusions must be adequately supported by evidence.
7 To help the employees become more communicative, the company offered several workshops to those who were not competent in social interactions.
8 Some parents try to help solve the problems that their sons and daughters have in adjustment to their college life.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	absorbed	**F**	bulk	**K**	functions
B	abundant	**G**	distress	**L**	hidden
C	accurate	**H**	efficiently	**M**	obliged
D	adjusted	**I**	evidently	**N**	official
E	beneficial	**J**	fictions	**O**	written

The Internet has made learning English much easier. English learners used to be 1) obliged to spend their time in libraries looking for the books that would help them in their language learning. It was very inconvenient because a lot of materials were 2) hidden in numerous textbooks and readers. But today content on a variety of subjects is only a click away. This is especially 3) beneficial for those who are serious about learning English.

In order to achieve fluency in English, you need to be comfortable using at least 10,000 words. The 4) abundant materials on the Internet make it possible for you to choose appropriate content to read and listen to. These materials can be 5) adjusted to your level if you input some keywords in the search engine. But how can you remember the 6) bulk of unfamiliar words?

In this case, the Internet 7) evidently makes it easier for you to learn vocabulary. You can use online dictionaries to instantly find out the specific meanings and grammatical 8) functions of new words. The Internet helps you 9) efficiently build up your vocabulary based on lively and interesting language content, which greatly reduces the 10) distress caused by your inability to remember the new words. The efficiency of this vocabulary learning is one of the reasons why the Internet has become an ideal place to learn the English language.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be allergic to be obliged to
become attracted to distinguish between
fresh from get lost get serious about
look upon … as run into

1 In Chinese culture, adult children are expected to take care of their aged parents, so they are obliged to contact or visit their parents regularly.
2 Most of the time, people don't really care about natural disasters and won't get serious about avoiding them till they are personally affected by one.
3 When you run into a friend that you haven't seen for a long time and have a good chat with him or her, you will surely be delighted.
4 While reading, we need to distinguish between facts and opinions in order to have a better and more accurate comprehension.
5 The growth of the food e-commerce sector in China has played an important role in promoting the sales of agricultural products fresh from the fields.
6 If I don't like someone or something, I might just say I am allergic to them, even though it sounds a little rude.
7 When the topic was discussed, I quickly got lost because I am not good at things like math and analytical skills.
8 It is hoped that some companies will become atrracted to this small old town to invest and build factories.
9 The Tang Dynasty is look upon as a golden age in Chinese history, when Chinese culture spread across much of Asia.

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 Why does the author say that the fairy tale is very similar to her experience?
2 Why does the author say that choosing a major can be a lengthy process of self-discovery?
3 What made the author want to become an engineer during her high school years?
4 Why did the author give up her high school dream after she entered college?
5 How come the author had a hatred of math later?
6 What made the author drop her second choice of a major – graphic design?
7 When did the author's prolonged hesitation over her major end dramatically?
8 Why does the author think journalism is the perfect balance for her?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 In your opinion, what makes choosing a major difficult?
2 In what ways can a major that suits you empower you in the future?
3 Are double major students more competitive in the job market? Why or why not?
4 Will the choice of a major affect students' future career? Why or why not?
5 Besides personal factors, what other factors can affect the choice of a major?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

artistic aspiration browse confirm
magnificence option prolonged
provoke release reputable

1 With the prolonged global fight against poverty still continuing, many countries are looking to draw inspiration from China.
2 According to the news release, her interest in writing about plants and animals came from her childhood.
3 Many of them are beginners who have never done painting before and are looking to develop their artistic interests.
4 Consumers are increasingly comfortable shopping using their mobile devices, with 69 percent of people browsing and shopping online last year.
5 The tourists were awestruck at the magnificence of the Great Wall, the building of which started as early as the seventh century B.C.E.
6 As we know, earlier diagnosis (诊断) can give better treatment options to patients, which will also help them get effective care.
7 Some clinics require people to call the front desk to confirm their appointments before they come to see the doctors.
8 The website is reliable because I've made dozens of purchases from this very reputable site with zero problems.
9 "What do you think the author meant when …?" is a common book club question, which provoke serious analysis of a topic.
10 Just as we all admire heroes, we look to others for inspiration and aspiration, but change has to start with you, as an individual.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	abilities	F	fortunate	K	options
B	absorbed	G	gain	L	passionate
C	competent	H	generally	M	portions
D	confine	I	inevitably	N	reputable
E	confirm	J	obsessed	O	resort

When choosing a college or major, you need to examine yourself: What are your 1) abilities and strengths? What are your weaknesses? What do you want out of life? Are you socially 2) competent or do you need family and friends' support in order to 3) confirm what you have decided is right?

Your college does not have to be bigger than your high school. Don't be 4) obsessed with the size of your college. Since a smaller community is more favorable for self-exploration, many 5) reputable colleges have a smaller student population. It is not the number of people, but the people themselves and the kind of school community in which you will learn that really matter.

You don't have to 6) resort to other people's help, but think about the people in your life who are happy and successful and find out where they went to college. You will 7) generally find that success in life has less to do with the choice of college than with the experience and opportunities you'll 8) gain while in college, coupled with personal qualities and traits.

There are many 9) options to major in, but you may need the variety and depth of college coursework to determine the major you are 10) passionate about. Whether you choose your major out of personal interest or for the needs of society and the country, you may possibly change your mind, even two or three times, before you finally settle on one.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

in awe　let sb. down　not up to par
obsessed with　passionate about
pick one's brains　throw … out　turn out

1 When I first saw the scenery of Mount Huangshan, I was in awe: the fascinating pine trees, the spectacular peaks, and the fairyland of clouds and mists.
2 The group discussion became heated, with creative ideas and suggestions thrown out from time to time.
3 Whenever there is a chance we can help these children, we make a top effort and don't want to let them down.
4 Science is not my profession, so if you want to discuss it, you could pick the brains of other people here who know science better than me.
5 I draw inspiration from many teachers who are passionate about their work and try to spread their enthusiasm to their students.
6 If you feel that your grades or your study skills are not up to par, you may turn to your teachers for advice.
7 I had never been to this restaurant before, but it turned out fantastic not only because of its delicious food but also the wonderful service.
8 If one is always obsessed with money, appearance, and social status, they will unfortunately forget what is most important in their life.

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 Why do people say "it's a must" when responding to the question about using instant messaging apps?
2 Who makes instant messaging apps work so well and become so popular?
3 Why do tech companies prefer to hire fresh graduates when recruiting new employees?
4 What do young employees dislike about management at work?
5 What does the invention of "Shake" by the young people illustrate?
6 Why does the author say that young people's work style is not conventional?
7 How do you know that these young employees have high aspirations?
8 Who will attract, motivate, and retain very capable young employees?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What could motivate people to join the work teams for instant messaging apps?
2 What are the most important factors that help the young app developers succeed?
3 Do you think the young app developers are representative of the young generation in China today? Give reasons.
4 What reasons can you think of to explain why the young generation is China's future?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

assign endure exhibit flexible
internal parallel persistence
recruit stunning vigorous

1 The boss said, "The schedule is completely flexible because I do not need to be around and watch when you do your work."
2 Currently, the stock market is not very stable, but over the long run, the growth of stock funds will parallel the growth of the economy.
3 These student volunteers can decide how to perform any assigned work, for which they are qualified and have a strong passion.
4 Human beings, by providing environmental enrichment, encourage animals to explore, interact, and exhibit natural behaviors.
5 Along with extraordinary courage, qualities like persistence, teamwork, and most importantly, leadership shine in all of our student activities.
6 This is a beautiful part of the city to live in, with stylish and architecturally stunning historic buildings lining the clean and quiet streets.
7 An energetic search will soon be put in place to recruit a qualified person who can continue with the leadership of a big company.
8 I've endured hardships throughout my life, so I think I can handle the stress and achieve my full potential in this company.
9 Many people believe that vigorous exercise and outdoor sports could better help people stay healthy and strong.
10 With the help of my family and friends, all of my internal doubts about myself gradually disappeared and my confidence was restored.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	academic	F	ethic	K	persevering
B	asserting	G	innovated	L	platform
C	assuming	H	motivated	M	released
D	dynamic	I	obey	N	remained
E	emerged	J	obsess	O	retain

Ms. Wang has been happy with her new job with a software company. "It offers a big 1) platform for me to develop, and I can learn much!" she said. Like Ms. Wang, a growing number of young Chinese workers are demanding that their voices be heard and 2) asserting themselves more in the workplace. Young people have become the main population in China's talent market, according to a report 3) released earlier this year. Therefore, many companies are doubling their efforts to attract and 4) retain this vital group.

Raised in the time of great social and economic change in China, this generation has 5) emerged as well-educated, highly resourceful members of the workforce. They are often in search of better learning and career-development opportunities. A study of the generation found that of employees who 6) remained with the same company for one to five years, more than 80 percent said that good career development was what 7) motivated them to stay with the company.

This generation doesn't just want to 8) obey orders. They want to participate in decision-making. They question authority and are 9) persevering in what they're pursuing. If companies want to keep on these talented employees, they have to make the workplace more 10) dynamic. Many companies have taken significant steps to create more flexible working environments, in an attempt to encourage employees to stay longer with the company.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be accustomed to be based on
for the sake of have a passion for
no exaggeration strive for
take it for granted that tap into

1 The course project that I completed weeks ago has helped me tap into my creativity and intuition which I didn't even realize I had.
2 Many people probably take it for granted that fast Internet access is almost everywhere – at home, at work, and even in the most remote areas.
3 It's probably true that we always strvive for the goal that we consider challenging but achievable to gain a sense of accomplishment.
4 It's no exaggeration to say that the kitchen he installed last month is 100 times better, and now I fortunately have the kitchen I dreamed of.
5 Since the exam is based on what you have learned, you can expect to see some questions from previous assignments.
6 I think journalists work in a timely manner and are accustomed to daily deadlines or tight working schedules because they were well trained in this way.
7 The situation between us is very challenging, but we have to learn how to handle the difficult situation for the sake of improving our relations.
8 The award-winning chef says that since he was young, he has had a passion for Chinese food because of its rich ingredients and well-balanced nutrition.

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 What's the purpose of showing the series of newly produced Chinese movies?
2 What did Huang write in his graduation album?
3 Why did Huang go to Britain to further his studies after he worked for a while in China?
4 According to the text, what was China's biggest deep earth exploration program?
5 Why did Huang prefer to be called "lunatic" but not "workaholic" by his co-workers?
6 How did Huang and his team help China greatly narrow its gap with developed countries?
7 During his last days of life, what did Huang wish he could do for future Chinese people?
8 How did Huang show his love and patriotism for the country throughout his life?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What are the most important qualities we should learn from Huang Danian?
2 Why do you think Huang Danian worked tirelessly for the motherland?
3 If you were a student of Huang Danian, what would you want to say to him?
4 What's your opinion about the importance of patriotism in the years of peace?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

chase exceptional explicit
fulfill maximize random resolutely
strategic survey typically

1 According to medical doctors, if a patient's tumor is small, surgery is ___typically___ performed to remove it.
2 These graduates brought deep-water ocean ___survey___ technology to the region to help explore the areas.
3 Here is my suggestion in terms of writing process: Before you start writing an essay, just jot down ___random___ ideas to do brainstorming.
4 It is important for athletes to have rigorous physical and technical training to ___maximize___ their performance in sports competitions.
5 After successful completion of these courses, students ___fulfill___ the academic requirements for their undergraduate studies.
6 Only three short straightforward words, but they were said so ___resolutely___ that all the audience were impressed.
7 This position would ideally suit candidates who have exposure to working on key ___strategic___ projects, preferably in the area of geophysics.
8 Internship, which gives you valuable work experience, can offer you a(n) ___exceptional___ opportunity to be competitive in the job market.
9 He understood that his ___chasing___ the dream was not for himself but for the people who had the same hopes and passions as him.
10 He gave us very ___explicit___ instructions on how to handle the new machine, so we all understood what he meant.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	absolutely	F	dictate	K	process
B	adequately	G	geophysics	L	prosperous
C	aspirations	H	imaginary	M	rejuvenate
D	compelling	I	inspirations	N	significant
E	detect	J	platforms	O	tedious

Dear students,

My field falls within basic science research – the mobile platform detection technology. As an important research field of 1) G geophysics, this technology is absolutely challenging. My work aims to develop mobile 2) J platforms for ships and vehicles, use geophysical detection equipment and technology to 3) K process multi-information, based on which to build models, and provide technical support for energy and mineral resources exploration. This technology can clearly 4) E detect what's down there two kilometers or more below the ground.

As China becomes a stronger and more 5) L prosperous nation, it needs many people who have studied abroad to return to the motherland and help with its modernization. I hope that we can together make 6) N significant contributions to the development of China's science and technology.

As the representative of your teachers, I would like to say that no matter whether your 7) C aspirations lead you to success or failure, no matter whether you are doing fine or not, and no matter whether your life is 8) O tedious or boring, you will always be in our mind because we care about you. As you are about to graduate from college and join in efforts to 9) M rejuvenate our nation, we'll share the responsibilities and happiness with you.

How time flies! I still remember the time when I was standing where you are now. It's 10) A absolutely my pleasure to come back to my alma mater after I graduated 18 years ago. No matter how many ups and downs you'll go through, I hope you can remember our college and return as often as you can. We'll cheer you on! Go! Go!

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

be entrusted to catch one's eye hole up
in urgent need of pass … down pay off
remain committed to stay on

1 When I was traveling in China, I would ride my bike slowly, take pictures of the things that caught my eye, and talk to people.
2 As a senior assistant in the lab for quite a few years, I was thrilled to be entrusted to teach lab techniques to the new students.
3 It was raining heavily, so she spent the whole afternoon holing up in her dorm room and reading.
4 We will build a closer partnership and remain committed to high-quality cooperation under the Belt and Road Initiative.
5 I went back to school to get my coaching certification, and my efforts and persistence paid off in the end.
6 She joined the lab as a summer student and then stayed on to complete her fourth-year honors thesis before graduation.
7 The traditions that are passed down from generation to generation will surely enrich our culture and be carried forward.
8 To fight against the common health crisis, China has made great efforts to help other countries in urgent need of medicines.

Reading comprehension

Understanding the text

1 Answer the following questions.

1 How do the messages we get contradict each other?
2 What are the two groups of customers called by the credit card company?
3 What is the upright message according to the text?
4 Why can't we escape from the permissive message of advertising?
5 Why does the author say that there is no shortage of ideas and things to buy?
6 How are people impacted by the two contradictory messages?
7 What does the author suggest students do to be financially healthy?
8 When will students steer their life in a successful and productive direction?

Critical thinking

2 Work in pairs and discuss the following questions.

1 What do you think of the student's dilemma – to spend or to save?
2 What strategies do you know businesses use to attract consumers?
3 How do you know you're overspending and should be alert?
4 In what other ways can you handle your money wisely, in addition to the ways mentioned in the text?

Language focus

Words in use

3 Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

budget defy dilemma diverse
loyalty manipulate objective
perspective tackle urge

1 The objective of the "upright" message is to ask people to save, while the "permissive" message asks people to spend.
2 If you find yourself in a(n) dilemma about what is the right decision for your career, speak to a career counselor.
3 It is important for parents to listen to their children's opinion because they may have a very different perspective on the things they've seen.
4 To cater for the different tastes of athletes from all over the world, the organizers of the Beijing Winter Olympics prepared diverse dishes.
5 If you want to save money for a rainy day, making a(n) budget is the first step you may want to take because it gives you a clear plan.
6 The Chinese legend goes that Yue Fei's mother tattooed four Chinese characters on his back to remind him of the importance of loyalty to the nation.
7 When children are addicted to online games, they would often defy their parents and stay online for hours every day.
8 The report goes on to urge the technicians to take a more active role in developing the standards of artificial intelligence.

Banked cloze

5 Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

A	appetites	**F**	manage	**K**	regulated
B	dilemma	**G**	manipulated	**L**	retain
C	engage	**H**	objectives	**M**	suspend
D	explicit	**I**	particular	**N**	sustain
E	explosive	**J**	perspectives	**O**	urgent

To spend or save is a question which many people have in their mind. They are always in a(n) 1) B dilemma whether they should spend the money that they have earned or save that money for the future. Well, there is no 2) D explicit answer to the question as different people have different 3) J perspectives on life, and that is the reason why some people tend to spend all their money while others 4) L retain control over their money.

People who spend all their money do not think much about the future. What they enjoy doing is to get pleasure from spending money. For example, if they like a(n) 5) I particular car, mobile phone, or laptop, they will buy it without giving it a second thought. For them, the most important thing is to satisfy their growing material 6) A appetites

In the long run, saving helps people 7) F manage their personal finances as saving helps an individual better plan for future 8) O urgent needs. From our everyday life, we can see that individuals who can 9) M suspend their spending save money successfully. Instead of buying things on impulse, they delay their purchasing decision and are not easily 10) G manipulated by commercial ads. Individuals who have responsibility for their family or their loved ones often belong to this group.

Expressions in use

6 Fill in the blanks with the expressions given below. Change the form where necessary. Each expression can be used only once.

at odds with　　do one's utmost
put … off　　retain control over
spin out of control　　stay on track
take in　　take stock of

1 My friend planned to travel to Europe in August, but I advised him to put off going till October when the weather is cooler.
2 The evidence obtained by the police was at odds with the statement he provided but consistent with what the witness described.
3 To retain control over its steady economic performance, China will work hard to ensure the supply of commodities and keep their prices stable.
4 The working team is well trained, so it has the ability to see, analyze, and react to issues before they spin out of control.
5 Both experts and teachers say that children tend to do their utmost when they see their parents making similar efforts.
6 As she entered the most dynamic period of her career, Kylie took stock of her success and the impact of her college education.
7 The chief executive is confident that current growth levels can be maintained since all the development projects stay on track.
8 It is very important for students to understand and take in new information; besides, they should judge the information carefully.